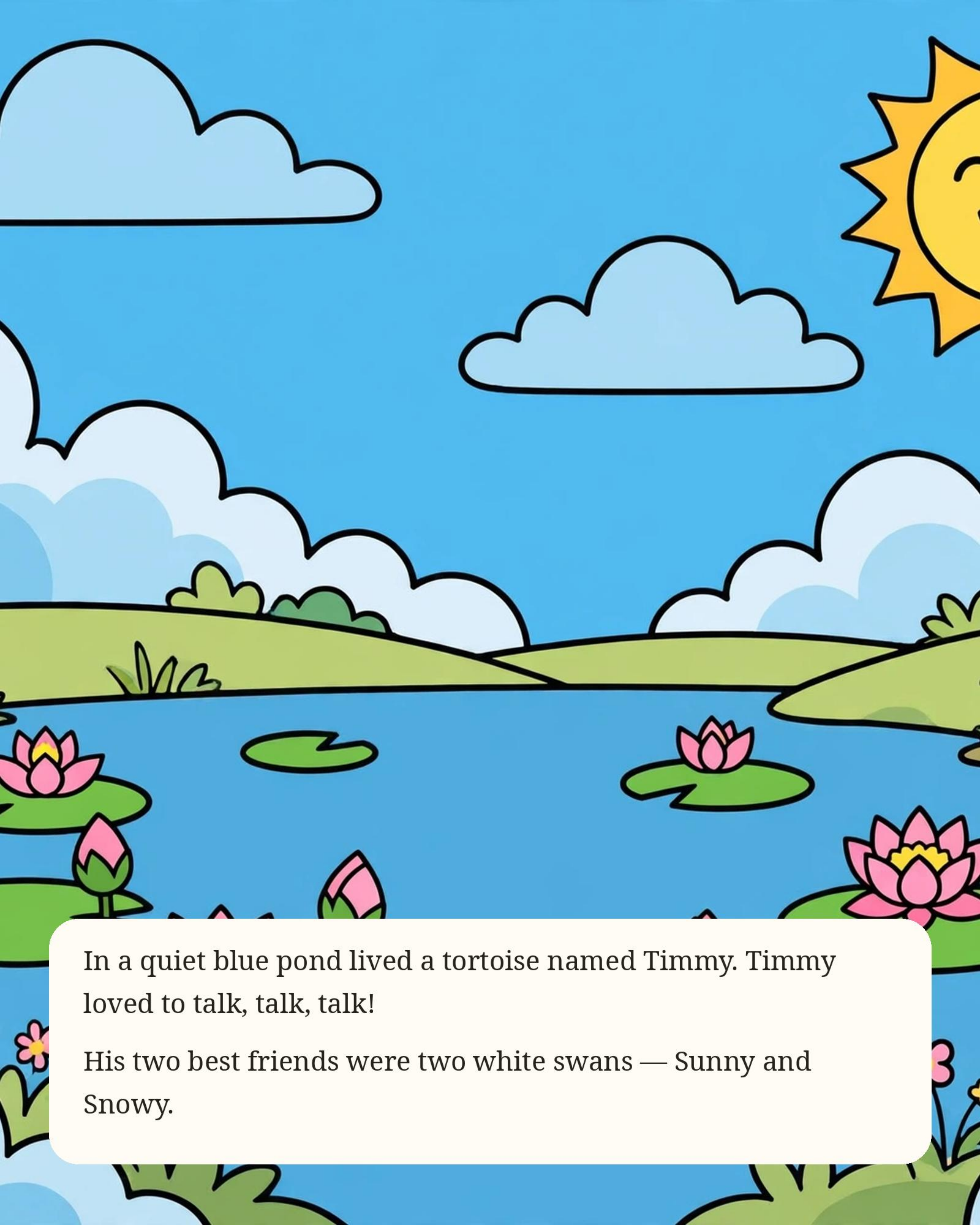


Classic Tales

The Talkative Tortoise

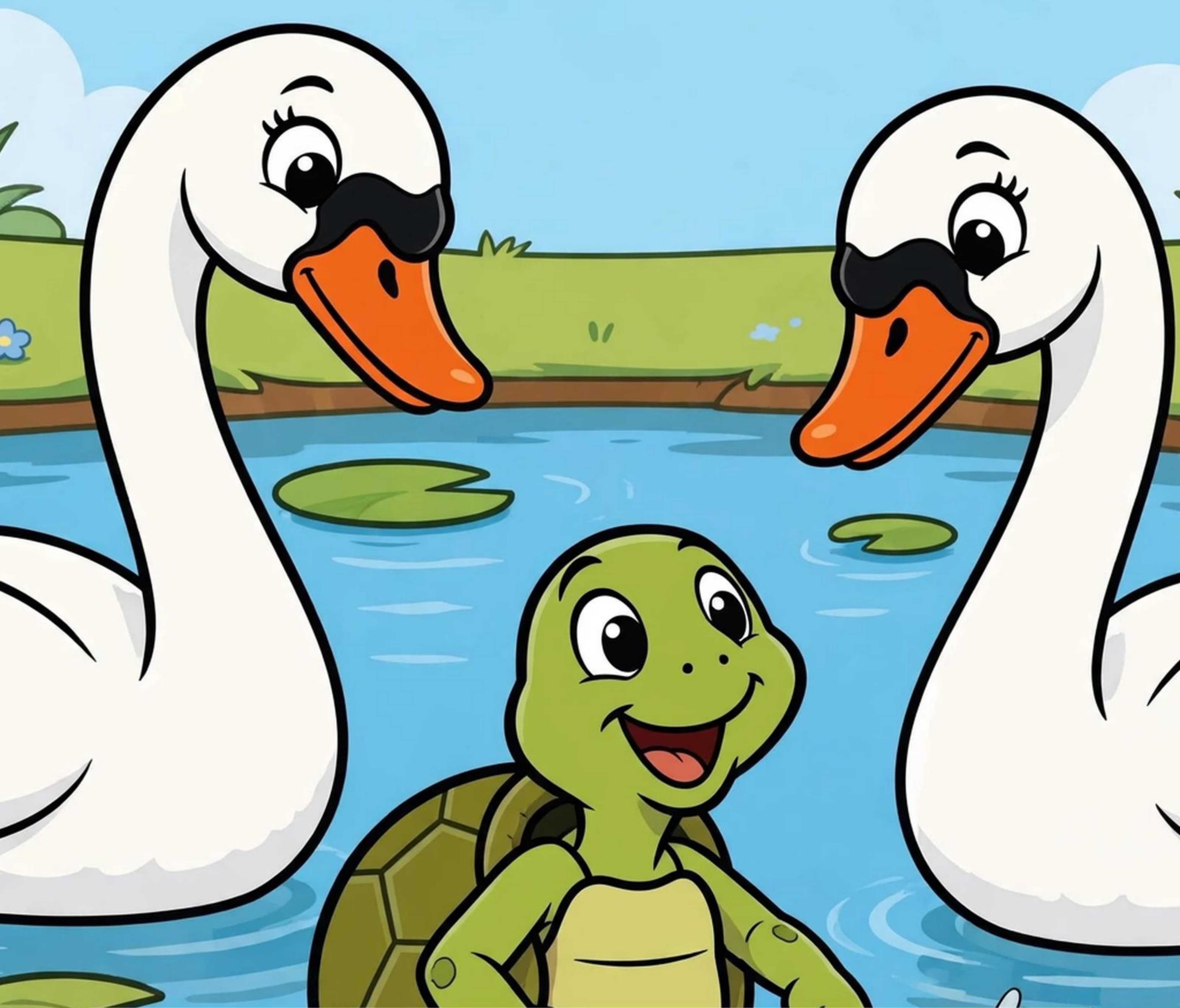


KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



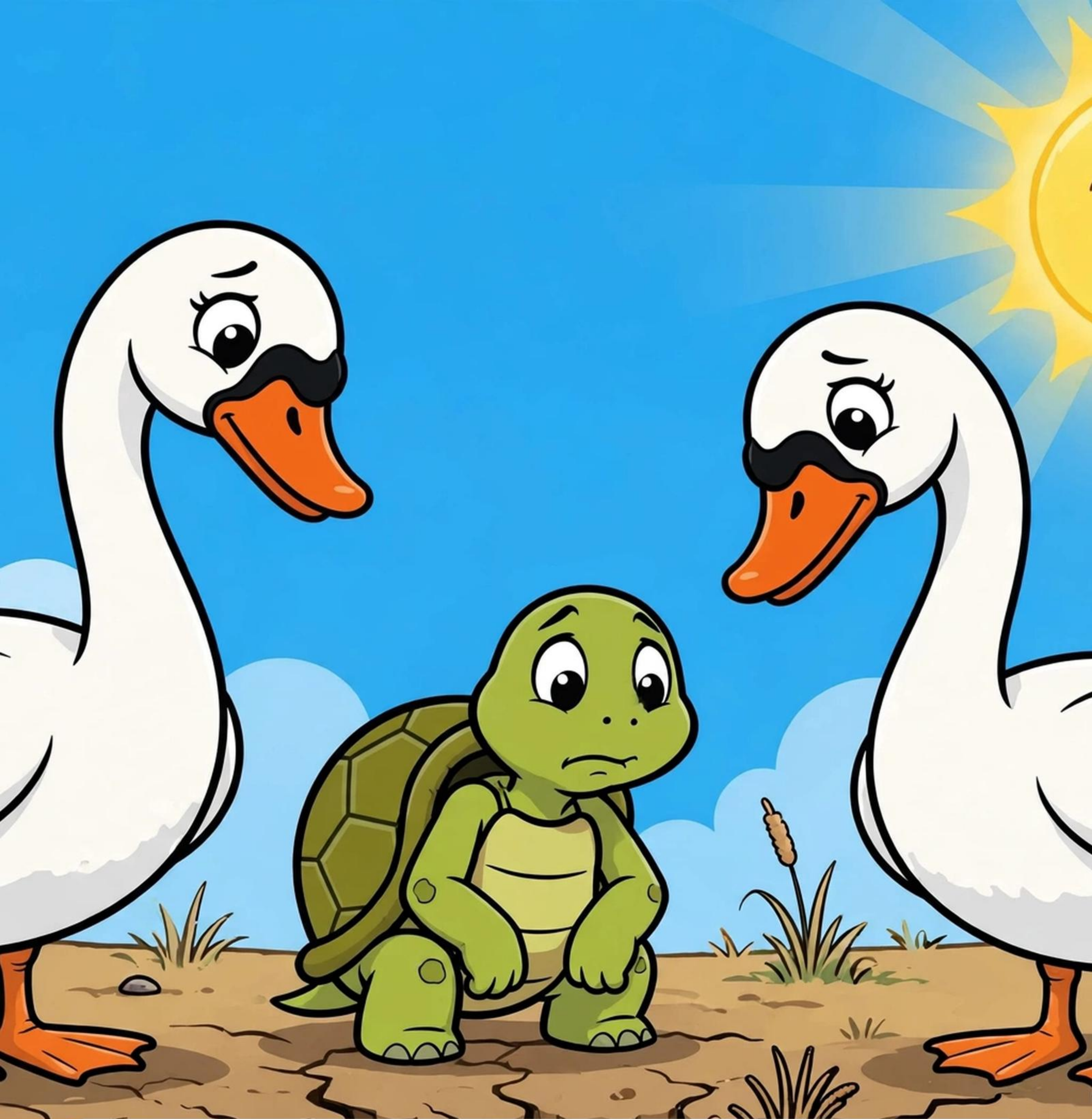
In a quiet blue pond lived a tortoise named Timmy. Timmy loved to talk, talk, talk!

His two best friends were two white swans — Sunny and Snowy.



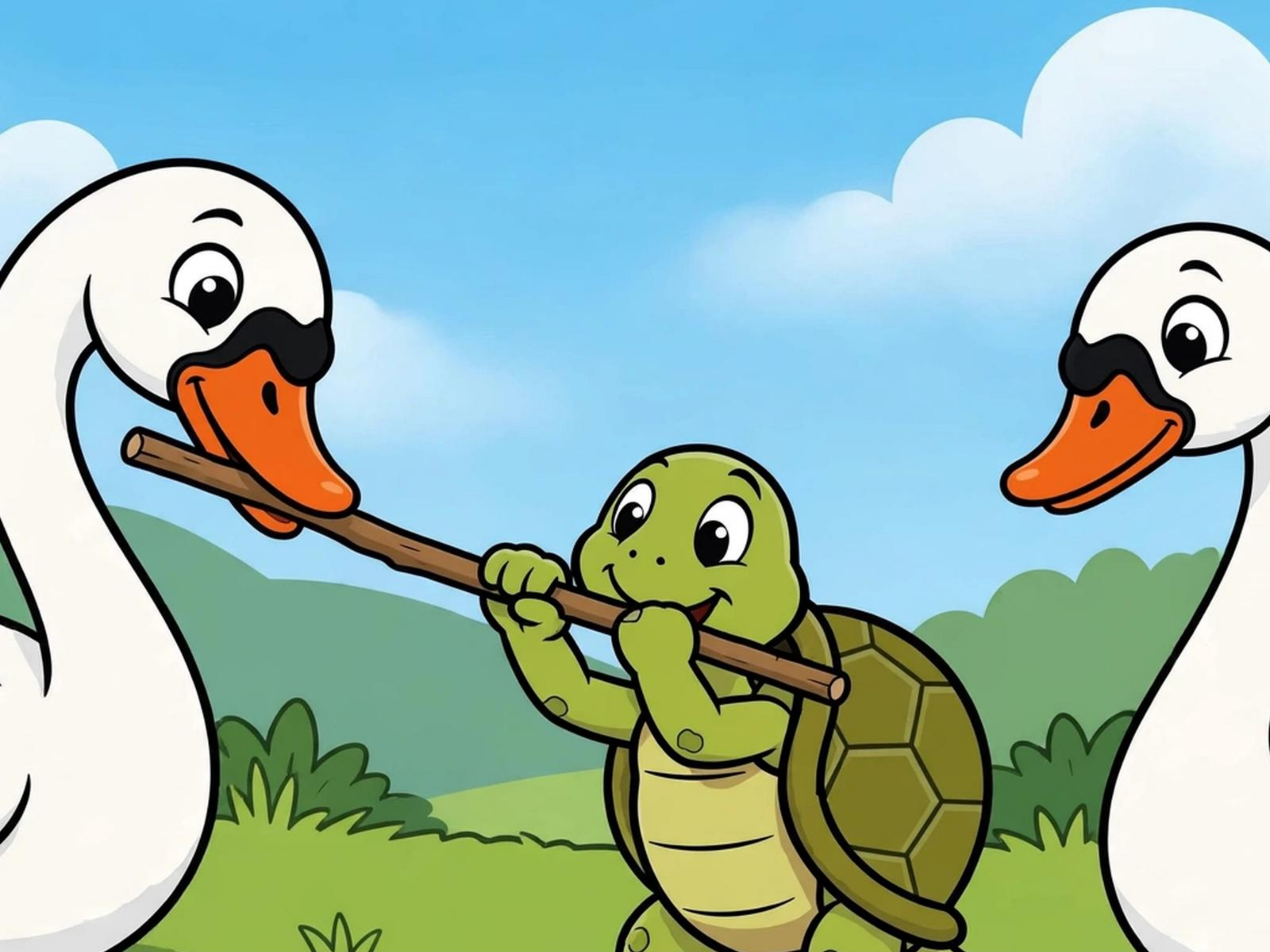
One summer, the sun shone so hot that the pond's water began to dry up.

"Dear friend," said Sunny, "we must fly to another pond. Come with us!"



"But I cannot fly!" said Timmy sadly.

Snowy flew off and came back with a strong wooden stick.



"Hold this stick tightly in your mouth," said Snowy. "We will each hold one end with our beaks and carry you through the sky. But there is one rule — you must not speak a single word on the way!"

Timmy clamped the stick in his mouth — chomp! The two swans gripped the ends with their beaks.



Flap, flap, flap! Up, up, up they flew, with Timmy the tortoise hanging in the middle!

Below them lay a little village. The village children looked up and pointed.

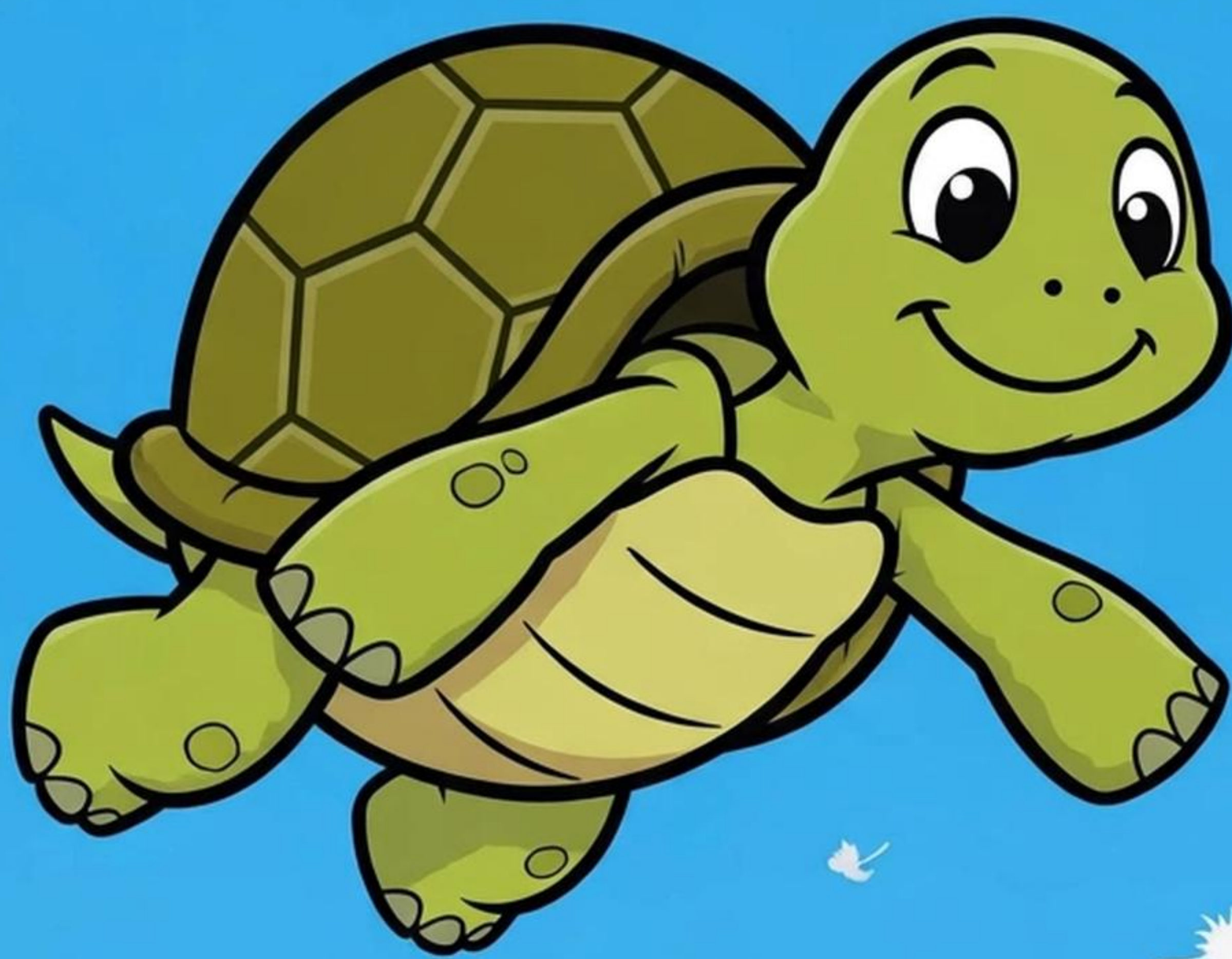


"Look! A tortoise is flying! A tortoise is flying!" they shouted. Timmy felt cross. "I will tell them—" he began, and opened his mouth —



Whoops! The stick slipped out! Down, down, down went Timmy — THUD! He landed on the soft green grass!

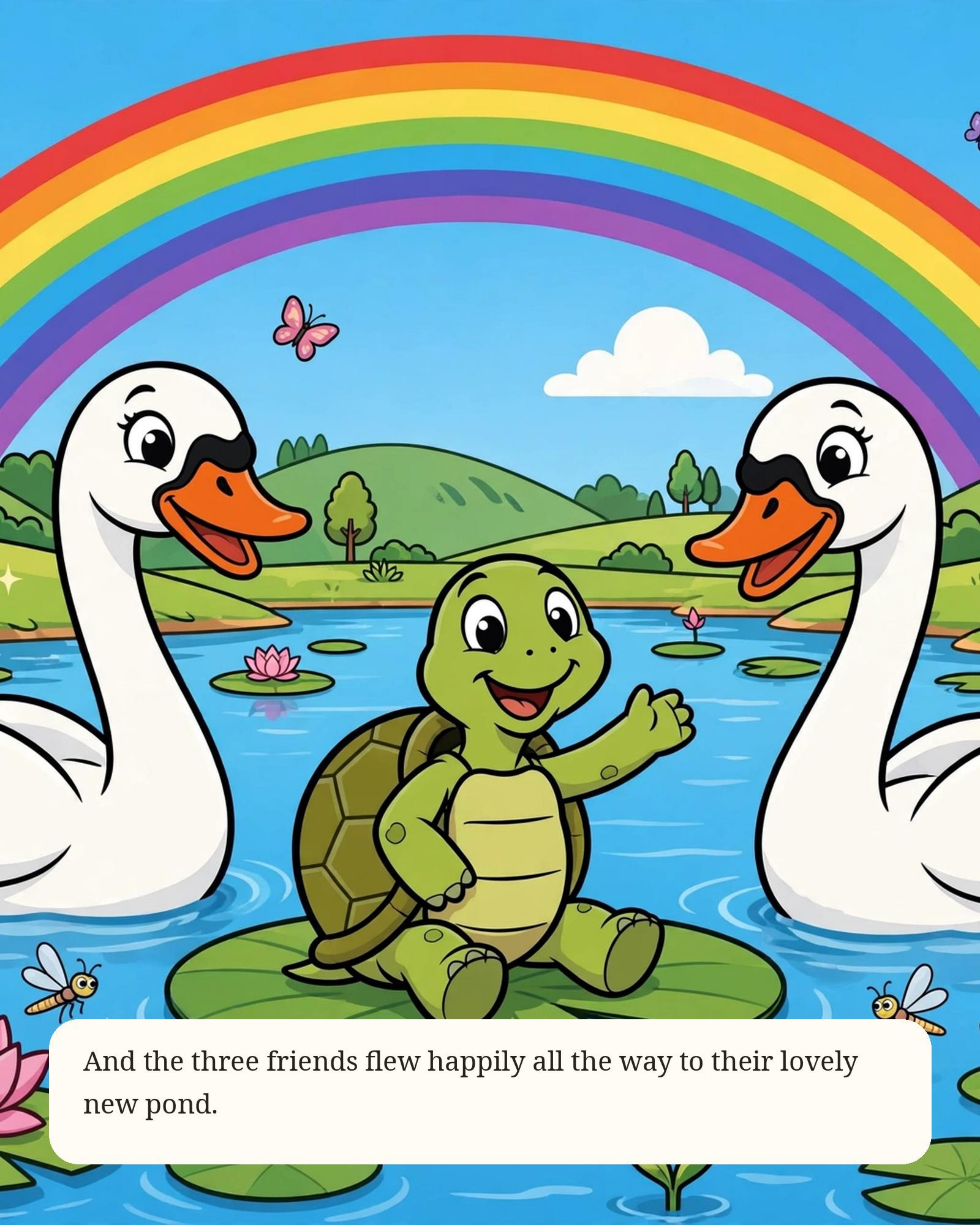
Luckily, he was not badly hurt. But Timmy had learned his lesson.



"I should have listened to my friends," he said quietly.
Sunny and Snowy swooped down and lifted him up again.



This time, Timmy held the stick in his mouth and did not say a word — not one little word.



And the three friends flew happily all the way to their lovely new pond.

**Listen to good advice — speaking
without thinking can get you into
trouble.**

The End

